

CORE EXTERIORS

Interlock Re-Level, Polymeric Sand & Seal

Professional Process Guide

For homeowners who expect lasting results — not temporary patches.

HPB Base Re-Level + Paver Relay + Techno Polymeric Sand + Techno Seal Penetrating Sealer

PREPARED EXCLUSIVELY FOR

Client Name _____

Property Address _____

Phone _____

Email _____

What's Included

A complete interlock restoration process for driveways, patios, and walkways: careful lifting of settled stones, HPB base rebuild with mechanical compaction after every step, precise paver relay, premium **Techno Polymeric Sand**, and a **Techno Seal** penetrating sealer that protects colour and extends lifespan — backed by our 3-year workmanship warranty.



Finished paver patio — level plane, crisp joints, professional sealed finish, protected with Techno Seal

Why This Process Matters

Sunken Pavers Are a Base Problem

Sunken or shifted interlock is almost never a paver problem — it is a base problem. Water movement, settling, and freeze-thaw cycles erode or compress the bedding beneath the stones. Simply lifting pavers and tossing sand or foam underneath is a temporary patch: sand washes out again, and foam compresses unevenly under load. The dip comes back.

CORE Exteriors rebuilds the base properly with HPB — High Performance Bedding — then compacts mechanically after every step, relays every stone true to pattern, locks joints with **Techno Polymeric Sand**, and finishes with **Techno Seal** penetrating sealer. That is the difference between a one-season fix and a restoration that lasts.

The Complete Package

- HPB base re-level — lift, excavate failed bedding, rebuild, compact after every lift
- Complete paver relay — pattern-true reinstatement of every lifted stone
- **Techno Polymeric Sand** — premium colour-matched joint sand, compacted and water-activated
- **Techno Seal** penetrating paver sealer — colour protection and lasting water resistance
- Site protection, debris removal, final inspection, and client walkthrough
- 3-year workmanship warranty on settlement attributable to our rebuild and relay

What You Can Expect — 9 Phases

- Phase 1 — Pre-job site assessment and photo documentation
- Phase 2 — Site preparation and surface protection
- Phase 3 — Careful paver lifting and removal
- Phase 4 — HPB base rebuild, compacted in stages
- Phase 5 — Paver relay, leveling, and compaction
- Phase 6 — Techno Polymeric Sand application
- Phase 7 — Water activation and curing
- Phase 8 — Techno Seal premium penetrating paver sealer
- Phase 9 — Final inspection, walkthrough, and warranty

Pricing & Timeline

Techno Polymeric Sand & Power Washing	\$2.00 / sq ft
Full Re-Level (lift, HPB base rebuild, relay, sand, seal)	Starting at \$8.60 / sq ft

Re-level pricing depends on the condition of the base and the total area affected. Every project starts with a free on-site walkthrough, where we confirm exact scope and provide a written quote before any work begins.

Typical Timeline

A typical 1,000 sq ft driveway takes **2 to 3 days** under good weather, with no rain and typical working conditions. Larger areas, poor base conditions, or weather delays can extend the timeline — we'll confirm an estimated schedule with you at the time of quote.

Which Service Do You Need?

Not every driveway or patio needs a full re-level. Here's a quick way to tell what your project likely needs — but every job starts with a free walkthrough so we can confirm the right scope in person.

Weeds growing in the joints, sand washed out, or the surface just looks dull and dirty — but the pavers themselves are flat and stable.	You likely just need Polymeric Sand & Power Washing .
A few pavers are loose, rocking, or slightly unlevel in isolated spots, but most of the surface is fine.	You likely need a spot Re-Level of those areas.
You're tripping over pavers, or you can see multiple sunken or uneven areas across the driveway or patio.	You likely need a full Re-Level of the surface.

Not sure which one applies to you? Please consult with us — book a free walkthrough and we'll tell you exactly what your driveway or patio needs, with no obligation.

Step-by-Step Process

Below is exactly what happens on a CORE Exteriors interlock re-level, polymeric sand, and seal project — from the first site walk to warranty activation. Every step is sequenced, and we compact mechanically after every base and reinstatement stage so the repair holds.

PHASE 1

Pre-Job Site Assessment

Before any pavers are lifted, we evaluate exactly why the surface moved. Fixing the symptom without understanding the cause guarantees the problem returns.

1.1 Settlement Mapping

We walk the full patio, walkway, or driveway and mark every sunken, lifted, or rocking paver. We measure depression depth and map the affected footprint so the repair area is clearly defined — no guesswork on site.

1.2 Cause Diagnosis

We identify what caused the movement: washout from downspouts or drainage paths, organic material under the base, ant or rodent activity, or bedding that was never compacted properly. The diagnosis shapes how deep we rebuild.

1.3 Joint & Drainage Evaluation

We inspect joint channels for sand loss, weed intrusion, and insect activity, and confirm surface water drains away from the home rather than pooling on the interlock field.

1.4 Before Photo Documentation

Dated wide-angle and close-up photos of affected areas, joints, and borders serve as your before-and-after record and our quality benchmark for the finished result.

1.5 Scope Confirmation

We confirm exact work boundaries with you — which areas are re-leveled and relayed, how repairs tie into borders and thresholds, and which elevations are included so the finished surface reads as one continuous plane.

1.6 Weather & Scheduling Check

Techno Polymeric Sand and **Techno Seal** sealer both require dry conditions. We verify the forecast — no rain for 24 hours before sand work and no heavy rain for 24 hours after activation and sealing — and communicate any date adjustments proactively.

PHASE 2

Site Preparation & Surface Protection

Professional work starts with protecting everything around the project. We treat your property with the same care we apply to the pavers themselves.

2.1 Clear the Work Area

Furniture, planters, grills, and any movable items are relocated to a designated safe area so nothing obstructs lifting, compaction, sanding, or sealing.

2.2 Landscape & Structure Protection

Adjacent garden beds, lawn edges, siding, and delicate borders are shielded. Lifted pavers and extracted bedding are staged on tarps — never directly on grass or gardens.

2.3 Surface Sweep & Debris Removal

The work area is swept clean so no surface debris ends up in open joints or under relaid pavers.

2.4 Paver Layout Reference

Before lifting begins, we photograph and, where needed, mark the existing paver pattern (running bond, herringbone, basketweave, borders) so every stone returns to its original position and orientation.

2.5 Material & Equipment Staging

HPB aggregate, plate compactor with protective pad, hand tamper, screed rails, levels, extraction tools, **Techno Polymeric Sand**, and **Techno Seal** sealer are staged for a clean, sequenced workflow — lift, rebuild, compact, relay, sand, seal.

PHASE 3**Careful Paver Lifting & Removal**

Pavers are removed by hand with proper extraction tools — never pried with screwdrivers or shovels that chip edges and scar faces.

3.1 Controlled Extraction

Each paver is lifted with extraction tools that grip the stone without chipping chamfered edges. We work methodically across the marked scope so the base can be corrected properly.

3.2 Stack & Sequence Management

Lifted pavers are stacked in order on protected staging so the original pattern, colour blend, and orientation are preserved exactly on relay.

3.3 Paver Inspection & Cleaning

Each lifted paver is inspected for cracks or spalling and cleaned of old bedding and joint sand on all faces, so it seats cleanly on the new HPB base.

3.4 Failed Bedding Removal

All compromised bedding — washed-out sand, contaminated fines, organic matter, and loose sub-base — is excavated and removed from site. We dig to sound, stable material; we do not build on top of the failure.

PHASE 4

HPB Base Rebuild — Compacted in Stages

This is the heart of the repair — and the reason our re-levels hold. We rebuild the bedding layer with HPB (High Performance Bedding), a clean, angular ¾-inch limestone chip. We never use loose sand or foam under re-leveled pavers.

4.1 Why HPB — Not Sand, Not Foam

HPB is angular, so particles lock together under compaction instead of shifting like rounded sand. It drains freely, so water passes through instead of washing the base out. Foam cannot be compacted, compresses unevenly under load, and traps water against the paver underside. HPB does none of that.

4.2 Sub-Grade Compaction First

Before any new material goes in, the exposed sub-grade is mechanically compacted. Every layer that follows is only as solid as what sits beneath it.

4.3 HPB Placement in Controlled Lifts

HPB is placed in controlled lifts — never dumped to full depth in one pass. Thin, even layers are the only way to achieve uniform density through the full profile.

4.4 Compaction After Every Lift

Each lift is mechanically compacted before the next is placed. This compact-after-each-step discipline eliminates hidden voids and soft spots that cause repaired areas to re-settle within a season.

4.5 Screeding to Final Grade

The final HPB layer is screeded to precise grade using rails and levels, accounting for paver thickness and matching the slope so water continues to drain away from structures.

4.6 Grade Verification

We check the screeded surface with a level and straightedge. The reinstated area must finish flush and in plane — slightly proud before final compaction, never low.

PHASE 5**Paver Relay, Leveling & Compaction**

With the base rebuilt and verified, every paver returns to its exact original position — and the whole repair is locked together mechanically.

5.1 Pattern-True Relay

Pavers are re-laid in their original pattern, orientation, and colour sequence from our Phase 2 reference, maintaining consistent joint spacing across the field and borders.

5.2 Individual Seating & Leveling

Each paver is seated and checked — no rocking, no lippage against its neighbours. High or low units are adjusted immediately, not left for the compactor to 'fix.'

5.3 Edge & Border Integration

Where the repair meets borders, soldier courses, steps, or thresholds, transitions are checked so the finished surface is indistinguishable from a continuous professional installation.

5.4 Full-Surface Compaction

The relayed area is compacted with a plate compactor fitted with a protective pad. This seats every paver firmly into the HPB bed and brings the surface to its final, uniform plane.

5.5 Plane & Drainage Verification

A final straightedge and level check confirms the surface is flat, flush, and draining correctly before any joint sand is introduced.

PHASE 6

Techno Polymeric Sand Application

Techno Polymeric Sand contains polymers that activate with moisture and harden in the joints — creating a flexible, durable bond that resists washout, weed growth, and insect intrusion.

6.1 Joint Preparation

Joints across the work area are cleared of old, contaminated sand and debris to a clean, uniform depth. New polymeric sand bonded over deteriorated material fails within a season — so the old material comes out first.

6.2 Sand Selection & Colour Match

We use premium-grade **Techno Polymeric Sand** matched to your existing joint colour and paver tone so the restored surface looks consistent and finished.

6.3 Dry Broadcast & Brooming

Sand is applied dry to a completely dry surface and swept diagonally across the paver faces with a hard-bristle broom until every joint is filled to the top — no voids, no partially filled channels.

6.4 Compaction Pass

The surface is compacted again — vibrating sand deep into the joints and settling it below the chamfer edge of the pavers.

6.5 Refill & Repeat

Joints settle after compaction. We repeat the broom-and-compact cycle until every joint is completely full and sand sits 1–2 mm below the paver surface — never flush or above.

6.6 Critical Surface Sand Removal

All sand remaining on paver faces is removed before activation using brooming, low-angle leaf blower passes, and hand inspection. Surface residue is the number-one cause of permanent polymeric hazing — we do not activate until the surface is 100% clean.

PHASE 7**Water Activation & Curing**

This phase locks the **Techno Polymeric Sand** in place. Rushing it is one of the most common causes of joint failure — so we never rush it.

7.1 Pre-Activation Final Check

Before any water is introduced, we walk the entire work area: all joints full, no surface sand remaining, plane and drainage confirmed. This is the last chance to catch issues before the sand sets.

7.2 Controlled Water Activation

Techno Polymeric Sand is activated with a fine mist — never a hose blast — applied evenly so water flows into joints without dislodging sand, following manufacturer-specified volumes.

7.3 No Flooding

Excess water washes unset polymer out of joints and causes incomplete bonding. We mist, pause, and assess — multiple light passes, never one heavy soaking.

7.4 Initial Cure Period

After activation, the surface should stay free of foot traffic for a minimum of 24 hours (and vehicle loads longer on driveways). We communicate timelines clearly before we leave the site.

7.5 Weather Protection Window

We schedule activation only when the forecast supports a proper cure. If weather shifts unexpectedly, we advise on temporary protection and any follow-up needed.

PHASE 8

Techno Seal Premium Penetrating Paver Sealer

Once **Techno Polymeric Sand** has cured, we seal the restored surface with **Techno Seal**. Sealer protects colour, repels water, and helps the surface stay cleaner longer — lasting protection on top of the structural rebuild.

8.1 Pre-Seal Surface Check

The surface receives a final blow-off and inspection. Any remaining dust or residue is removed so the sealer bonds cleanly to a dry, dust-free face.

8.2 Penetrating Sealer Application

We apply professional-grade **Techno Seal** penetrating paver sealer evenly using controlled spray and cross-hatch passes. The sealer soaks into the paver face and joint edges without changing the natural look or texture.

8.3 What Sealing Protects Against

Techno Seal helps resist colour fade and surface weathering, slows moss and algae on the paver face, and reduces water intrusion into joints — extending the life of both the paver surface and the polymeric sand bond.

8.4 Seal Cure Window

After application, the surface requires a minimum 24-hour cure before foot traffic, with additional time before furniture or vehicle loads — stacked on top of the polymeric sand cure timeline from Phase 7.

PHASE 9

Final Inspection, Walkthrough & Warranty

We do not leave until the job meets our standard — and you have seen the result.

9.1 Quality Inspection Checklist

We verify: surface flush and in plane, no rocking or lippage, all joints filled and activated, **Techno Seal** applied evenly, no hazing on paver faces, protected areas undamaged, and all equipment and debris removed from site.

9.2 Before & After Comparison

We review the Phase 1 before photos alongside the finished surface so you can see the full transformation — level plane, crisp joints, sealed professional finish.

9.3 Client Walkthrough

We walk the project with you, explain what was done in each phase, and answer any questions. You sign off on completion before we close the job file.

9.4 Aftercare Instructions

We provide guidance on foot and vehicle traffic timelines, sweeping, drainage awareness, and what to avoid in the first 30 days — including pressure washing joints and harsh cleaners on the **Techno Sealed** surface.

9.5 3-Year Workmanship Warranty Activation

Your three-year workmanship warranty is activated at completion. If settlement attributable to our base rebuild or relay occurs within three years, contact us and we will assess and correct it at no additional charge.

Driveways, Patios & Walkways

Representative finished work — the quality standard behind this process.



Interlocking stone driveway



Poolside paver patio with charcoal borders, sealed with Techno Seal



Front entrance herringbone walkway



Finished interlock patio — level field, clean joints, Techno Polymeric Sand joints

Warranty & Next Steps

3-Year Workmanship Warranty

CORE Exteriors warrants the workmanship on your re-leveled, relayed, and sealed interlock for three (3) years from completion. If settlement attributable to our base rebuild or relay occurs within that period, we will assess and correct it at no additional charge. This warranty covers settlement of the repaired surface; it does not cover damage from abuse, excavation by others, or drainage changes made after our work.

Materials We Use

We rebuild every base with HPB (High Performance Bedding), lock joints with **Techno Polymeric Sand**, and protect the finished surface with **Techno Seal** penetrating sealer. These are the same premium-grade products behind every re-level, relay, and seal job we complete.

Aftercare Essentials

- Wait 24 hours before foot traffic; allow longer cure before furniture or vehicle loads.
- Sweep regularly; keep downspouts and drainage directed away from the restored area.
- Avoid pressure washing joints for the first 30 days; use mild soap and water on Techno Seal sealed surfaces.
- If you notice any movement, call us early — covered under your 3-year warranty.

Ready to Restore Your Interlock?

Book a complimentary site assessment. We'll document the settlement, confirm scope, and prepare a written proposal for your property.

Luke Cairns | 519-712-1431 | coreexteriors@gmail.com | coreexteriors.ca